

Problem 4. Tangkhul Adjectives

Solution:

Reasoning:

Given: Kachui = tall, kaphaa = good, katyeo =small, kathi = to die/ dead, kathum =three, phangaa= five.

Kachuiashinaao	Tall woman
Katyeoa shim	Small house
Kaphaalairik	Good book
Kathithingrong	Dead tree

From the given data, and these forms with their English translation, we can infer that

shim = house; shinaao= woman; lairik =book; thingrong =tree

Comparing the following sentences,

Thingrongpingthidalai (Trees are dying)

Thingrong-chi thira (That tree will die)

Thingrong-chi chuire (That tree will be tall)

I-nakhamong-chi shungra (I will close the door)

Aa-nakhamongshunga (He closed the door)

We can infer that the adjectives can follow the nouns they modify and when they do, their ka-beginning is omitted and the rest of the form takes tense/aspect markers such as –ra=will, dalai=is –ing, -a =past tense.

If we see the data in the table above, we can see that the adjectives can also precede the nouns that they modify, and when they do, the adjectives retain the ka-beginnings and in addition are suffixed with –a. If the adjectives end in a consonant (kashung) or in –aa (kaphaa), or –i (kathi), then the –a is not added. (This is more precise a solution. An alternative solution is: If the students reason as follows: The adjectives ending in –ui or –eo get attached with –a and other adjectives do not get –a attached.).

The ordinal adjectives are formed by attaching ka- to the beginning of the number words. Adjectives such formed can precede the nouns, and unlike the other adjectives they do not drop their ka beginning. We infer this from the sentences such as

Hi kaphangaalairikna (this is the fifth book).

By comparing the sentences in the data and their English translations, we extract aa=he, I=I, hi=this, chi=that, -ping =plural marker.

Solutions:

Q.A)

The good house: **Kaphaa shim**

He wrote five books :**Aa-nalairik-phangaapama**

He is writing the fifth book: **Aa-nakaphangaalairik pam delai**

The small woman: **katyeoashimnaao**

The small woman closed the **second** door: (A mark should be given to students, since there is an error on part of the paper-setters)

He will be small: **Aatyeora (Aa-natyeo-ramaybe** granted half a mark)

That is a dead tree: **Chi kathithingrongna**

This tree is dead: **Thingrong-hi thi**

This door is closed: **Khamong-hi shunga.**

Q.B] In this language, -a is attached to the adjectives if they occur before the nouns they modify (e.g. in 1, 2, 3, 4, 9 etc). If they occur after the nouns, they act like verbs and can be attached with the tense affixes, such as –a in simple present and past (as in 7), -ra for the future tense (as in 15, 16), and dalai for continuative tense (as in 14). The verbs take exactly the same forms (23, 24). The ordinal adjectives are formed by attaching ka- to the beginning of the number words. Adjectives such formed can precede the nouns, and unlike the other adjectives they do not drop their ka beginning.

It seems that in this language, the adjectives and the verbs act exactly alike. In other words, there is no difference between the categories of adjectives and verbs.